2013 Dodge Challenger SXT

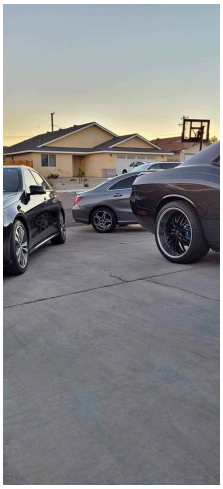
$8,700 · 113,000 miles · Private seller · Ridgecrest, CA

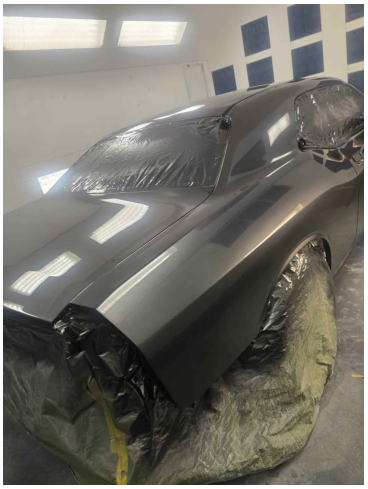
Seller: Private seller

Source: Facebook Marketplace

Listing: https://www.facebook.com/marketplace/item/1405437455036959/

Report generated October 28, 2026 · Ridgecrest Car Finder









+ 6 more photos in the app.

Out-the-door price	Monthly cost to own	Reliability
$9,749	**$665**	**Average**
Set a budget in the Cost Calculator tab to compare.	loan + insurance + fuel + repairs + registration	3/5 · 5 recalls · 179 NHTSA complaints

Budget — buying it

Vehicle price	$8,700.00
Use tax (9.25%) — paid at DMV	$804.75
Vehicle license fee (0.65% of price)	$56.55
Registration + CHP fee	$108.00
Transportation improvement fee	$65.00
Title transfer	$15.00
Total out-the-door	$9,749.30
+ Pre-purchase inspection (you pay the shop)	$150.00

California taxes the full price — a trade-in does not reduce sales tax. DMV fees are estimates; the CA DMV fee calculator gives exact amounts.

Budget — paying for it

Down payment	$5,000.00
Amount financed	$4,749.30
Monthly loan payment (60 mo @ 7.5% APR)	$95.17
Total interest over the loan	$960.67
Cash needed up front (down payment + inspection)	$5,150.00

Budget — owning it each month

Loan payment	$95.17
Insurance (estimate, full)	$196.00
Fuel (1,000 mi/mo @ 21 MPG, $4.75/gal)	$226.19
Maintenance & repair reserve	$130.00
Registration renewal (÷12)	$17.21
Total per month	$664.57

Running costs without the loan: **$569/mo**. Estimated first-year cost of ownership: **$17,061** (out-the-door + inspection + 12 months of running costs + loan interest).

The repair reserve is set from the reliability rating and mileage: money to set aside, not a forecast.

Insurance

Coverage	Typical Ridgecrest range	Estimate used
Liability only (CA minimum 30/60/15)	$71–$163/mo	$102/mo
Full coverage (liability + collision + comprehensive)	$137–$353/mo	$196/mo

The budget above uses the **full coverage** estimate ($196/mo). Get real quotes and enter one in the app to replace it.

• Vehicle class: sporty coupe/sedan. Estimates assume an adult driver with a clean record; age, record, credit, and coverage limits change the price a lot.

• Ridgecrest is one of the cheapest places in California to insure a car (about $107–110/mo average).

• A lender will require full coverage. On an older, cheap car paid in cash, liability-only can make sense — but you'd pay for your own repairs after an at-fault accident.

• California's minimum (30/60/15) is low; $100k/$300k/$100k liability is commonly recommended.

• Ask about military/government discounts (NAWS China Lake), bundling, and low-mileage discounts.

Reliability

Rating: Average (3/5)

Average. 3.6L Pentastar V6 + 5-speed auto is a durable combo with maintenance, but early (2011-13) engines had a left cylinder head defect. 179 complaints, mostly electrical.

NHTSA data for this model year: 5 recalls · 179 owner complaints (6 involving a crash). Most complaints: Electrical System (104), Engine (27), Air Bags (19), Power Train (16), Steering (15), Unknown Or Other (11).

Known issues for this model

• Left cylinder head defect (cyl #2 valve seat) on engines built before mid-2012/2013 - misfire, ticking

• Plastic oil filter housing cracks -> oil and/or coolant leaks (very common)

• Rocker arm wear ('Pentastar tick')

• Electrical issues (most-complained category)

• Big 22" wheels: expensive tires, harsh ride, bent-rim risk

Check on this car before buying

• Check build date on driver door sticker

• Listen for ticking from driver's side at idle

• Look for oil/coolant leaks at the back of the engine valley (oil filter housing)

• Ask if cylinder head was replaced under warranty

• Scan for codes (P0302 / P0304 misfires)

Notes

$8,700, 113k, automatic, grey/black. Clean title, paid off, claims bought new + maintained. New tires, 22" rims, fresh oil change, SMOG DONE, backup camera, tint. Listed Oct 18.

3.6L V6 Pentastar: early (2011-13) engines had left cylinder head valve-train issue (ticking, misfire cyl 2) - listen for tick. 22" rims = expensive tires, harsh ride.

Ask for service records since new. Local - easy to see.

2026-10-23: LISTING REMOVED - no longer on Facebook Marketplace (likely sold).

Vetting checklist (0/12 done)

- [ ] Checked KBB/Edmunds fair price
- [ ] Recalls checked / completed
- [ ] Clean title in seller's name
- [ ] Test drive incl. highway & hills
- [ ] No overheating; coolant clean
- [ ] Pre-purchase inspection
- [ ] VIN decoded & matches listing
- [ ] History report (Carfax/AutoCheck/NMVTIS)
- [ ] Valid smog cert (< 90 days)
- [ ] A/C cold after 15+ min
- [ ] Tires OK (tread, dry-rot, DOT date)
- [ ] Written out-the-door price

All costs and insurance figures are estimates for planning, not quotes. Confirm fees with the CA DMV, rates with insurers, and the car's condition with an independent pre-purchase inspection.